Main brief

What the business needs from Data and Analytics

From	Chief Operating Officer
To	Devon-Lee Allies, Data and Analytics
Subject	Three questions I need answered before the next credit committee
Scenario	Fictional South African consumer lender. All data is simulated (Nov 2024 to Oct 2026).

Where we are

We lend small unsecured personal loans through our app, our branches and 12 referral partners. Growth is fine. Losses are not: too many loans go bad in the first six months, and I cannot tell which of our partners are making us money. Our data sits in six files from different systems that nobody trusts, and every analysis starts with someone cleaning them by hand.

The questions I need answered

#	Question	Brief	Answer by
1	Can we trust our data, and can we rebuild it the same way every time?	Data Pipeline Case Study Brief	Week 2
2	Can we predict which new loans will default in the first six months, and does that beat the cut-off we use today?	Credit Risk Case Study Brief	Week 5
3	Which referral partners and campaigns make us money, and which do not?	Partner Performance Brief	Week 7

Question 1 comes first because 2 and 3 depend on it. I do not want two analysts producing different numbers from the same files.

What I will do with the answers

- Decide whether to change the approval rule and whether the committee should see a model-based alternative.
- Decide where to spend more, where to cut, and which partner contracts to renegotiate.
- Decide whether to invest in a proper data platform.

What I expect from you

- Plain language: I am not a data scientist. Tell me what you found, how sure you are and what could be wrong.
- Honesty about weak evidence. A small, uncertain improvement is a fine answer if that is what the data shows.
- Work I can re-run, not a one-off spreadsheet.
- Respect for customer privacy (POPIA) and fairness: the model must not use sex or province as inputs.

Out of scope for now

Pricing, collections strategy, and changes to partner contracts (I will decide those from your recommendations).

Each question has its own detailed brief with the data, constraints and what to hand back. Start with Question 1.